

05-13-2025 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sZiter3VIM0
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Municipal Meeting Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order [00:01:23](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heater, Mrs. Barnes-Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Love, Dr. Washburn, and President Williams.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Williams.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence [00:01:31](#) followed by the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance [00:01:52](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Not explicitly covered in the provided transcript segment.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:02:26](#) **Superintendent's Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds, Superintendent.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Reynolds highlighted the upcoming launch of an advertising and media campaign for the Freshman Academy at Central High School, featuring cartoons and promotional spots on Wolfboom radio. He also congratulated the North Side Middle School choir department for winning the all-music award from the Indiana State School Music Association and reminded families that district enrollment and form updates are open via the online portal. Additionally, he introduced Jeff Holloway as the new boys basketball coach and athletic director.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Informational report only; no board vote required.
- **00:15:21 Financial Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Derome presented the April financial information. The total checkbook balance exceeded \$33 million across multiple funds, district enrollment stood at 4,872, and the state loan balance was reduced to \$7.2 million (with monthly payments increasing to \$185,000 in July). He noted uncertainties stemming from state legislative actions (such as SB1) and textbook rental revenue integration into state basic grants.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:20:36 Food Service Contract (Chartwells)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the 2025<U+2013>2026 school year contract for the food service management company following a formal five-year bid review process overseen and approved by the Indiana Department of Education (IDOE). Four companies submitted bids, and Chartwells was recommended.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:33:10 Family and Student Handbook (2025<U+2013>2026)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grim.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the proposed student and family handbook for adoption. Key updates include integrating the Sandy Hook Promise system (eventually replacing the school safety tip line), adding language for the new weapons detection system (currently at Central High School, page 36), and updating technology language regarding Google Workspace and YouTube access (page 38).
 - **Action & Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:27:34 Employee Handbook Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Bell.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented updates to the employee handbook. Notable changes include adjusting life insurance coverage from \$60,000 to \$50,000 to avoid non-cash taxable benefit penalties for employees under IRS rules, and updating retirement/termination language for support staff.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:31:38 Public Hearing & Bond Resolutions (\$19.8 Million Project)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome, Chief Financial Officer / Board President.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board conducted the second statutory public hearing regarding a prospective bond issue and project not to exceed \$19.8 million. Funds will address deferred maintenance, including HVAC/boiler replacement and potential air conditioning at the Fieldhouse, chiller replacement and bleacher work at North Side Middle School, 16 exterior door sets (over 50 doors) at Central High School, 50,000+ square feet of district roofing, and track/tennis court resurfacing at Southside Middle School and Central High School. Officials emphasized tax neutrality due to expiring older debt.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **00:40:12 Rick Yenser** (Newsman and Author) questioned whether the bonds are short-term or 20-year, expressed concern over a lack of public awareness among local labor and contractors, raised questions about union labor utilization, and cautioned against property tax increases driven by surging assessed valuations during economic uncertainty.
- **Action & Disposition (Project Resolution):** Approved by Voice Vote **00:47:33**.
- **Action & Disposition (Preliminary Determination Resolution):** Approved by Voice Vote **00:48:13**.
- **Action & Disposition (Reimbursement Resolution):** Approved by Voice Vote **00:49:10**.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *(Note: Public comments regarding the primary bond project occurred during the statutory public hearing detailed in Section 4. No general citizen forum remarks outside of the agenda items were recorded at the conclusion of the transcript.)*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - High school graduation is scheduled for June 2nd, and board members were reminded to secure their graduation robes **[00:2:09]**.
 - Discussion touched upon third-grade literacy score improvements and ongoing monitoring of legislative impacts regarding school consolidation and virtual education.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote following a motion and second **00:56:02**.